Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

February 2026

PROMOTION OF HANDMADE GETS SCALE, BIG SCALE

One District One Product

Craft communities in India are supported by a combination of government schemes, NGO interventions, and private sector initiatives. These efforts aim to bridge the gap between traditional skills and contemporary market demands, creating market access and ensuring the sustainability of hundreds of craft forms.

One of the best-conceived and implemented government initiatives is the One District One Product (ODOP) scheme, first carried out in Uttar Pradesh in 2018. A program that promotes uniquely location-specific products, it has now been expanded to 713 districts across 27 states and UTs, covering traditional food, spices and other local products alongside indigenous handicrafts and handmade textiles. For our purpose we look at the impetus given to the last category.

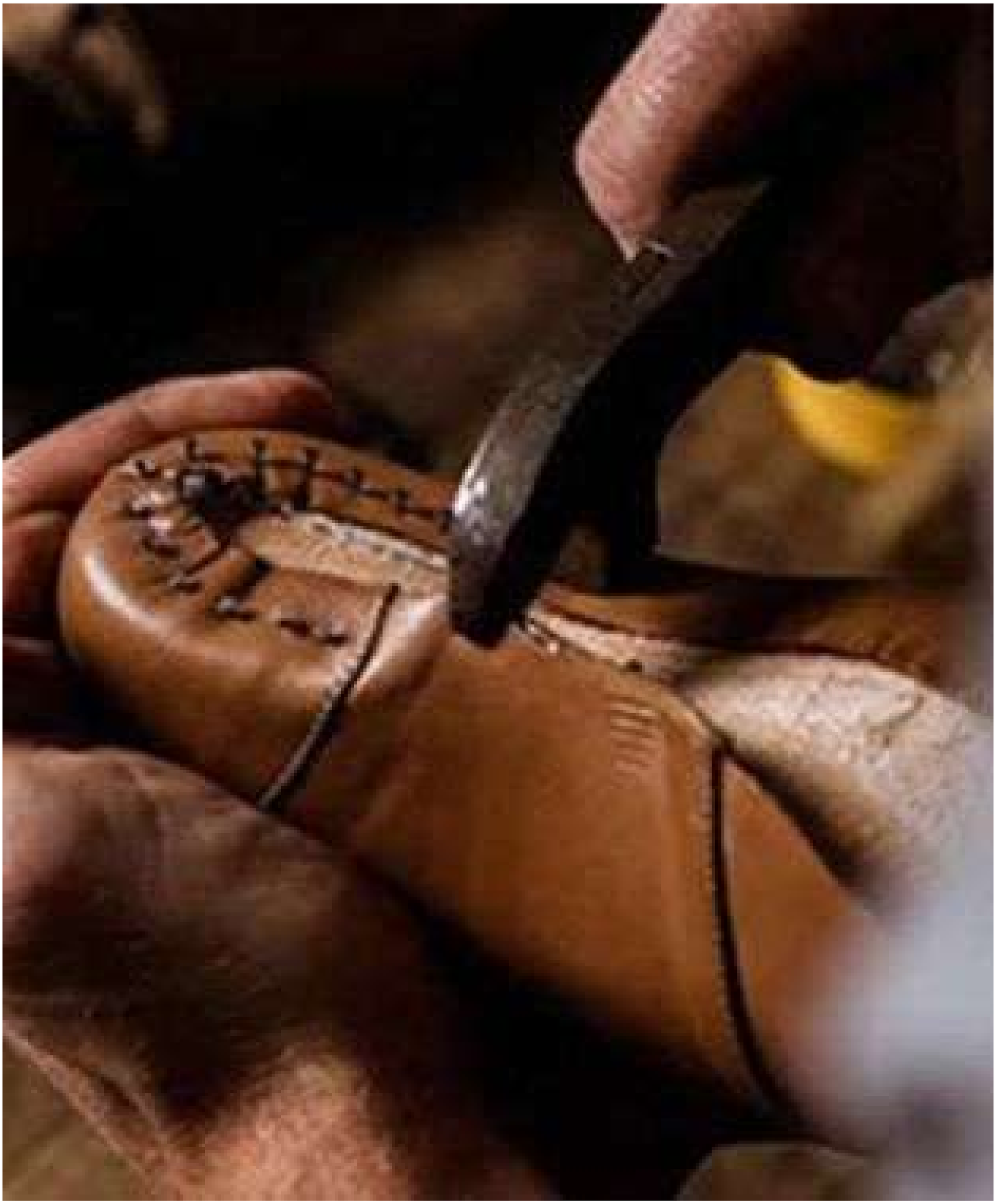
Since the start of the program, handicraft projects worth Rs 4,000 Cr have been sanctioned under the ODOP Margin Money scheme.



Floor coverings made in the Bhadohi-Mirzapur region, hub of the largest, hand-knotted carpet weaving industry in Asia



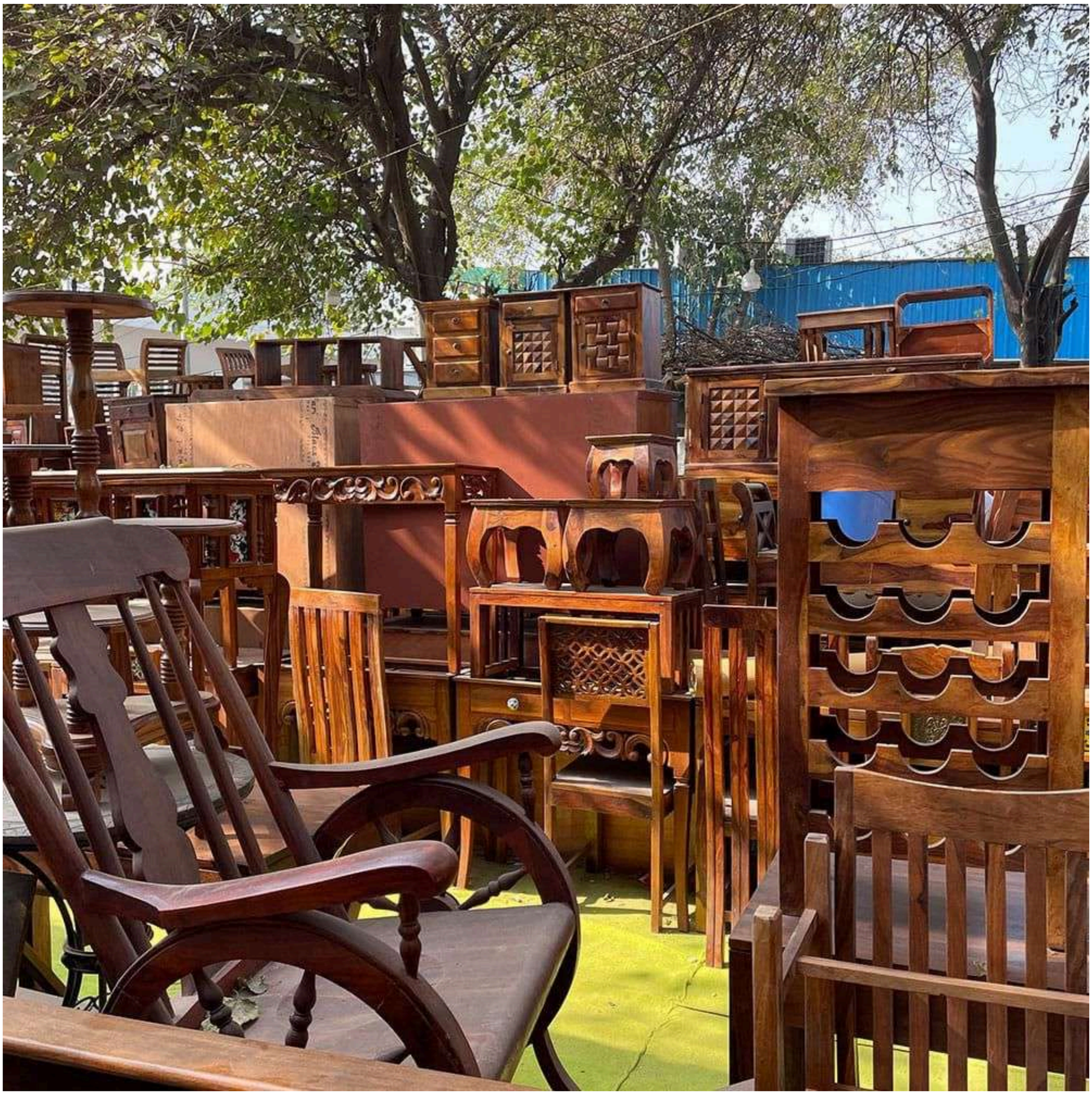
In the same period, more than 1 lakh artisans have been trained and provided with modern toolkits under the ODOP Skill Development program.



Micro, small and medium leather-making units in Agra get better at their age-old craft…



...as do woodcraftsmen in Basti, using teak, sheesham, sal, mahua and jamun. To rich effect.



Many craftspeople have participated in international events such as the Dubai Expo 2021 and the Bharat-Sri Lanka Maitri Utsav 2024 besides various domestic events such as the ODOP Summit, Hunar Haat and Dilli Haat.





From Jalaun district, handmade paper made from cotton cloth and hosiery waste has a growing demand in these eco-conscious times



On the other hand, Amroha dholaks and tablas have a niche but high-value discerning market



As is now evident, ODOP success stories lie in dozens of handmade craft forms.



15thC hand-weaving traditions continue to thrive in Lalitpur silks



The famous wooden toys of Varanasi compete with an emerging new market for exquisitely finished soft toys from Jhansi



Below, Firozabad glass in infinite forms, is a perennial best-seller







Combed banana fibre from Kushinagar can hold its own against the best of basketry anywhere


Kushinagar's
ODOP Magic
Kushinagar, Uttar Pradesh

The way forward

After the success of ODOP in UP, several of the other 26 states are implementing it in their districts. This is Centre and State support for handmade at its most robust.

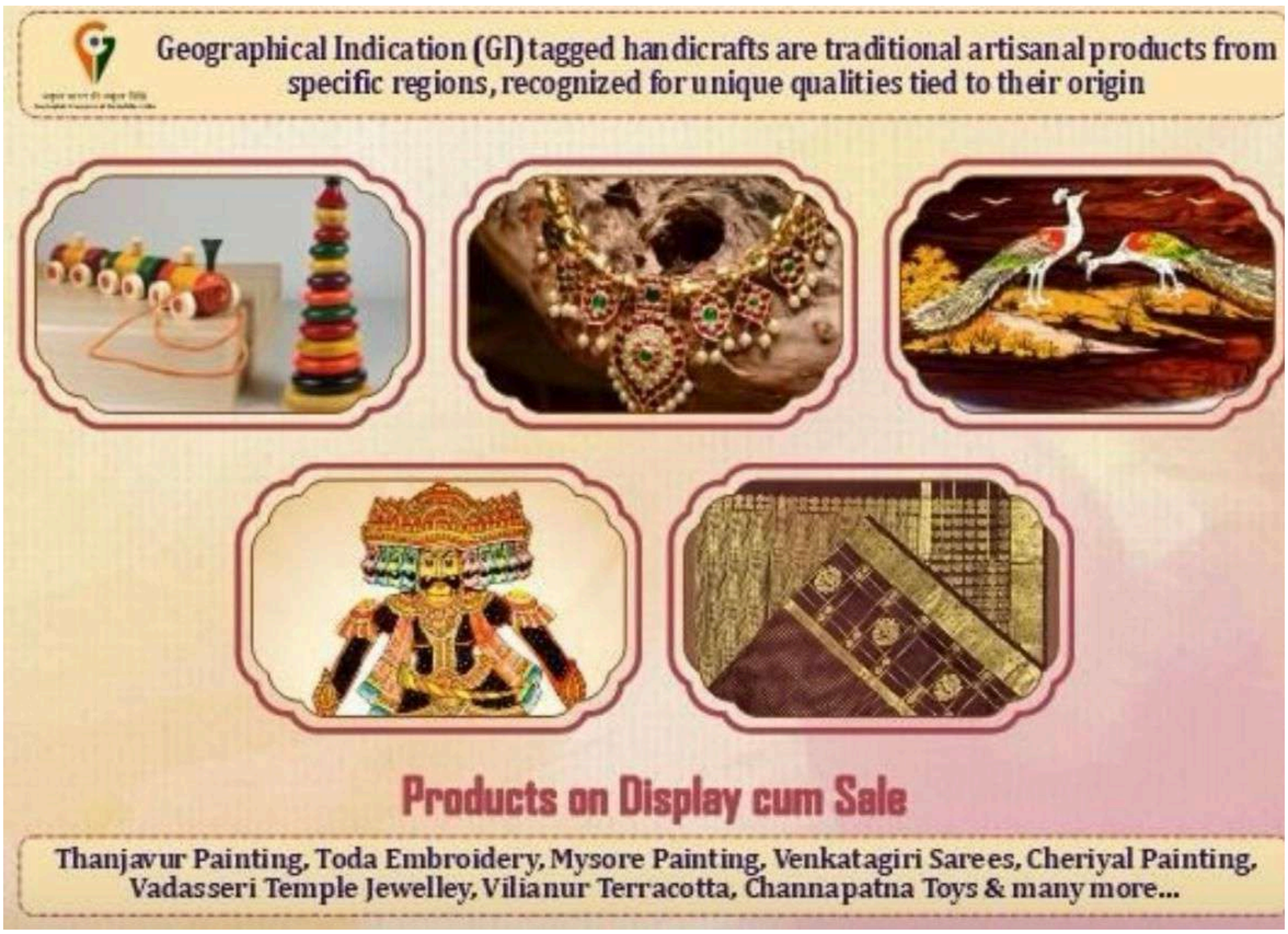
See if you can hook up the local crafts communities you know to your nearest ODOP office, e.g. Search ‘Government of Tamil Nadu ODOP’.

Or, start with this link.

https://msmeonline.tn.gov.in/odop/pdf/catelogue_new.pdf

How else can we help?

While the ODOP projects gather speed independently, the reputed GI tag is increasingly being awarded to a number of location-specific handicrafts.



Notice the list at the base of this photo for example. Maybe we could look out for them when we go craft shopping.

ODOP CREDITS

1. Government of India
2. State Government of UP